

CASE STUDY :- Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying is a form of online harassment where individuals are targeted through digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or emails. A widely documented case is that of Amanda Todd, a teenager who faced prolonged online abuse.

How the crime happens (step-by-step):

The incident began when Amanda was persuaded by an online stranger to share a private image during a video chat. The perpetrator saved the image and later used it to blackmail her, demanding more content. When she refused, he created fake social media accounts and circulated the image among her peers. This triggered widespread harassment—classmates mocked her, and strangers sent abusive messages. Even after changing schools and accounts, the perpetrator repeatedly tracked and targeted her, continuing the cycle of bullying.

Who is usually targeted:

Cyberbullying commonly affects teenagers and young adults, especially those active on social media. Victims are often chosen due to vulnerability, social isolation, or simply being different or visible online.

Consequences:

The consequences can be severe and long-lasting. Victims may experience anxiety, depression, low self-esteem, and academic decline. In Amanda's case, the continuous harassment led to extreme emotional distress and social withdrawal. Cyberbullying is particularly harmful because it is persistent (24/7), widely visible, and difficult to escape, amplifying its psychological impact.

Conclusion:

This case highlights how cyberbullying escalates through anonymity, repeated exposure, and group participation, making it a serious digital crime with real-world consequences.